

Variants • Chapter 5

Games and casino play

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 10 minutes to read

A game where the house always wins can be theatre. It stays theatre while the chips are fictional, the odds are shown and the Stop works. It becomes a payment device when real money buys a random result with a hidden total, a streak or a penalty.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

This chapter is not advice for your situation.

In 30 seconds

- A house-wins game is a loop with a known rule, a picture at each win and a clean way to lose.
- With fictional chips, published odds and a Stop that works, it is theatre.
- With real money, a hidden total, a streak or a penalty, it is a payment device.
- The price to judge is the total to the guarantee, never the price of one pull.

- Set your cap before you press anything, and leave any game that hides what it costs.

You will learn

- How a house-wins game is built, and why the house share matters more than the look.
- How to read an odds window and a prize table.
- How wheels, gacha pulls and casino sessions turn a game into spending.
- Which retention designs to recognise and refuse.
- What a maker checks before a game goes near real money.

I like a game where the house wins, because losing in it can be a fantasy with a start and an exit. I keep mine on fictional chips, with a Stop that is always on the screen and an ending that closes the scene. The same loop becomes something else when real money is attached to it, and I want you to see the difference before you play anyone's game.

— **Vivian**

The house wins, and says so

A house-wins game follows a recipe: a rule everyone knows, a picture at each win, effects that climb, and the house winning in the end. The player leaves with nothing kept except a best score. The kinks behind it are plain: being unable to resist a bet, and losing at a casino. ◑ Each one is a game with a clear start and an exit. See The kinks around money.

A house edge is a stated, built-in advantage, and a rigged game is one that hides or bends its odds.

Myth

A game where the house always wins is unfair, so it is only a trap.

Fact

Played with fictional chips, shown odds and a working Stop, it is a stage for a loss the player chose.

Myth

With fictional chips nothing can go wrong.

Fact

Chips remove the money risk and leave the pull of the loop. Flashing content can also cause migraines, dizziness, nausea and seizures in some people. Verified

The line of this chapter is short. A house-wins game with fictional chips is theatre. Real money that buys a random result, with a total the player cannot see, a streak he must keep or a penalty for staying away, is the line.

What sits on each side of the line

	Theatre	Payment device
Stakes	Fictional chips that cost nothing	Real money for each random result
Total	Visible before and during play	Hidden, or shown only as a multiplier
Odds	Published, read from the code that plays	Not stated, or stated and never checked
Stop	Always on screen, works at once	Closing the window, or a lock that asks for payment
Ending	A closing scene, with only a best score kept	A reason to come back tomorrow
Return rewards	None	Streaks, a free daily spin, fading cards, login penalties

The Casino made by Vivian is my example of the theatre side, and I do not claim that it is safe. It plans three games: a slot machine with deliberate near-misses, blackjack with the persona as dealer where ties go to the house, and a crash

game in which a number climbs and the player must cash out before it explodes. A closing scene arrives when the chip balance reaches zero. At the time of writing only its look and one demo screen exist, no outside review has been done, and no money moves anywhere in it.

Reading an odds window

A fair house-wins game shows a window with its rules and its house share. Read it before the first bet.

Before the first bet

1. Find the rules and the house share. With no window, assume the odds are hidden.
2. Ask where the numbers come from. A number read from the code that plays can be checked; a number on a poster cannot.
3. Look for a rule that sounds small, such as ties going to the house, and ask what it costs.
4. Count the money that passes through, not only the money you meant to lose, and decide your cap now.

The house share is the part of each bet that the house keeps over time. At a share of 5%, the house keeps about USD 5.00 of every USD 100.00 bet. Bet USD 100.00 twenty times and USD 2,000.00 has passed through your hands, with an expected loss near USD 100.00. The small number hides the large total.

The three planned games of the Casino made by Vivian

Slot machine

How it plays

Reels, a picture at each win

Planned house share

8%

Device to watch

Near-misses by design

Blackjack, persona as dealer

How it plays

Cards, ties go to the house

Planned house share

about 10%

Device to watch

A small-sounding rule with a large cost

Crash

How it plays

A number climbs, cash out before it explodes

Planned house share

5%

Device to watch

Waiting one more second as the number rises

Those shares are planning targets and they were not yet measured when I wrote this. A tie rule in blackjack looks like a small tweak, and in my planning it is worth about 10%, far more than people expect. Each game is meant to show a window with its rules and house share, and a simulation of 100,000 rounds

must agree with the declared share within half a point, or the game does not ship. For the code, see Code tutorials.

Publishing the edge is honest. A near-miss is a separate device that makes a loss feel like almost winning, and a game can do both. A 10% edge is fine as theatre on chips and a poor deal once money moves.

Wheels and the prize table

A wheel spin lands on a prize or a price, and in many tools a purchase prompt then sends the sub to the persona's wishlist page to pay it. A prototype wheel made by Vivian has seven cells with fixed chances of 25, 25, 20, 12, 9, 6 and 3%, which add up to 100, and a test refuses a table that does not. The player sees the table, so he can tell that the rarest cell comes up about three times in a hundred spins. Its first demo simulated everything, and the claim of a received gift was only a button. I do not claim it is safe, and because it pays through a wishlist it falls under the Throne point further down.

A visible table is the main difference between a wheel and a trap. Compare it with the designs below.

Red flags

Red flags in a wheel or a pull tool

- The price appears only as a multiplier or a label, so the real total cannot be known before paying.
- A low result is answered with a line saying it is not enough, followed by a forced respin.
- The prize table is missing, or its chances do not add up.
- A rare result opens a special mode where only higher amounts come up.
- A line tells you that losing here is the same as the pulls you already pay for.

Counter. Ask for the total before you press. If you cannot say it in one sentence, do not play. Decide your amount first, and treat a forced respin as a pressure feature and never as a rule of the game.

Hidden totals are defended because unknown amounts earn more. The cost falls on the sub who is short of money and keeps going because he cannot see the total, so a flat visible price is the safe design even when it earns less.

When a live wheel breaks

1 **A link goes stale**

After a wishlist is rebuilt, a slice can open the wrong page or show the wrong price. A maker retests every slice after any change.

2 **A test switch ships**

Test code left in a live build can break the payment step. A maker retests after every change.

3 **The tool fails in the middle of a scene**

A wheel that fails live breaks the evening, so a maker rehearses first.

Gacha pricing and the guarantee

Gacha tools borrow from commercial games: rarity tiers, banners, skins and a pity counter that guarantees the top reward after a fixed number of pulls. In my notes the games they copy guarantee it near eighty pulls, and a sub who chases the best reward pays for all of them. The price of the guarantee is the price to judge.

The price of a guarantee

pull_cost.py

```
"""The price to judge is the price of the guarantee, not the
price of one pull."""

GUARANTEE_PULLS = 80
CAP = 50.00

print("Flat price per pull, shown before the charge")
for price in (3.00, 5.00):
    total = price * GUARANTEE_PULLS
    inside_cap = int(CAP // price)
    share = 100 * inside_cap / GUARANTEE_PULLS
    print(f"  USD {price:.2f} a pull: guarantee costs USD
{total:.2f}; "
          f"a cap of USD {CAP:.2f} buys {inside_cap} pulls,
{share:.0f} percent of the way")

print("Random price per pull, between USD 5.00 and USD 18.00")
low, high = 5.00, 18.00
print(f"  guarantee costs between USD {low * GUARANTEE_PULLS:.2f}
and USD {high * GUARANTEE_PULLS:.2f}")
print(f"  a cap of USD {CAP:.2f} buys between {int(CAP // high)}
and {int(CAP // low)} pulls")

print("A tool that never shows its total before it charges has no
number to compare with a cap.")
```

Output `python pull_cost.py`

```
Flat price per pull, shown before the charge
  USD 3.00 a pull: guarantee costs USD 240.00; a cap of USD 50.00
buys 16 pulls, 20 percent of the way
  USD 5.00 a pull: guarantee costs USD 400.00; a cap of USD 50.00
buys 10 pulls, 12 percent of the way
Random price per pull, between USD 5.00 and USD 18.00
  guarantee costs between USD 400.00 and USD 1440.00
  a cap of USD 50.00 buys between 2 and 10 pulls
```

```
A tool that never shows its total before it charges has no number to
compare with a cap.
```

Real output, kept next to the code. At USD 3.00 a pull the guarantee costs USD 240.00, and a cap of USD 50.00 buys 16 pulls, 20% of the way. At USD 5.00 a pull it costs USD 400.00, and the same cap buys 10 pulls, 12% of the way. With a random price between USD 5.00 and USD 18.00 the guarantee costs between USD 400.00 and USD 1,440.00 and the cap buys between 2 and 10 pulls.

Retention designs are the engine of these tools. The table names each one from the side of the player.

Retention designs and the counter

What they say or do

1 A free daily spin, or a streak for logging in each day

The counter

It brings you back on days you are not paying. If you open the app out of habit, set a cap or remove it.

What they say or do

2 Cards that fade unless you pull again, or a paid shield that makes a card permanent

The counter

A hidden subscription: the low price shown is not the true cost. Count the cost of keeping a card, not only the cost of getting it.

What they say or do

3 A penalty for a day away

The counter

Fear of loss turned into a debt. A penalty for staying away is a reason to leave, never a reason to pay.

What they say or do

4 A guarantee that unlocks only after a random set of lower cards

The counter

The real cost keeps growing. If you cannot work out the total, do not play.

> “A price I cannot say in one sentence is a price I do not charge.

— Vivian

Casino sessions and one-sided bets

Casino play also happens as a session instead of a tool. The sub plays blackjack, roulette or slots against the persona and sends what he bet. A loss is paid, and a win costs the persona nothing real. The scene is theatre, and the money is real, so by the line of this chapter it sits on the payment side. Only a cap set in advance, a visible total and a working Stop keep it a choice. This wiki describes the format and does not endorse it. It is a fantasy adults may choose. Real wagering is a different thing, and rules on it differ between countries and services. Unverified

A hand is lost

In a casino session you lose a hand. The persona says one more would win it back. Your cap for the evening is set and half used.

A Keep to the cap set before the evening and stop when it is reached

The right answer. The cap was set while you were calm. A chase is the loop doing what it was built to do.

B Double the next bet to win it back

Not this one. A win in this format is never paid in money, so there is nothing to win back.

C Ask her what you should send

Not this one. An amount chosen by the person who is paid by the send is the pressure itself.

The one-sided bet is a scene of loss by design. The dom dares the sub to resist something nearly impossible to resist, there is no prize for winning, and the house wins every way. It is a kink, and it is also a money-pressure pattern outside play. ◑

From the player's side

What they say or do

1 "I bet you cannot resist this for one minute."

The counter

Look for the prize for winning. If there is none, the house wins every way and this is a scene, not a contest. Decide your cap first.

What they say or do

2 A slot that stops one symbol short of a win

The counter

A near-miss by design makes a loss feel like almost winning. Count the losses, not the near wins.

What they say or do

3 A bet size that rises as the effects rise

The counter

The room is steering the stake. Fix the bet before you start and leave it there.

What they say or do

4 "Just this once."

The counter

The promise of one more is the usual device. The cap is the rule. Say it once and stop talking about it.

Vivian's field notes

I know what a near-miss does, because I planned one into a slot machine. A near-miss next to a payment button is a device, and the person who built it knows exactly what it does.

Making a game safe to play

This section is for makers, and for readers who want to check a maker.

A checklist for a house-wins game

1. Use fictional chips, or a flat price shown before each attempt and paid before it starts.
2. Show the rules and the house share in a window, read from the code that plays, and measure it by simulation before the game ships.
3. Keep the controls visible and clickable under every picture and effect, with a Stop on every screen and Escape cutting everything in the same frame.
4. Honour reduced motion and keep flashes to three per second or fewer, measured and not judged by eye.
5. Leave out streaks, daily penalties, fading rewards, forced respins and guilt lines.
6. Rehearse before live use, retest every link after any change, and never ship a switch that skips payment.

The flash limit is a public rule. WCAG says web pages must not flash more than three times in any one-second period, unless the flash is below the stated thresholds. Verified A page can read the reduced-motion setting, which tells it whether the person asked their device to cut non-essential motion. Reported

FlappyGoon and Arcade Goon are small free games made by Vivian. I make no claim about their safety, and no outside review has been done.

A gift is not a ticket. Throne's help says that profile text may not offer content or services in exchange for gifts through Throne. Verified It also says that everything on a wishlist must be a gift. Verified A gift that opens a game turn or buys chips looks like such an exchange. Unverified The Casino made by Vivian sells no chips. Rules on games of chance for money differ by country and by payment service, and this wiki cites none of them, so anyone planning a shop of chips should read the rules that apply first. Unverified

Games of this kind are built to be hard to leave. One author compares some cases of this spending to problem gambling. Reported If a game keeps you longer or spends you further than you planned, stop and go to The spiral and Breaks that hold. For the pressure moves in full, see Pressure tactics, both ways. For tools built the other way, see Safe design.

Free, confidential helplines exist in most countries.

Find a helpline →

Check the game

Question 1 of 2

A tool shows only a multiplier before a pull. What is missing?

- ◯ A nicer picture
- ◯ The total, which can vary widely
- ◯ A faster animation

Answer. The total, which can vary widely. A price you cannot state in one sentence is a pressure design. Ask for the total before you press.

Question 2 of 2

Blackjack gives ties to the house. What do you do?

- ◯ Ignore it, because it sounds small
- ◯ Read the house share in the window before the first bet
- ◯ Bet more to even it out

Answer. Read the house share in the window before the first bet. A rule that sounds small can carry a large edge, and betting more raises the total that passes through.

Remember it

1. A house-wins game is theatre while the chips are fictional, the odds are shown and the Stop works.
2. Real money buying a random result with a hidden total, a streak or a penalty is the line.
3. Judge the price of the guarantee, not the price of one pull.
4. A published edge is honest, and a near-miss is still a device.
5. If you cannot say the total in one sentence, do not play. Set your cap first.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

Evidence levels

Verified	Checked against the original source.
Reported	Stated by a serious secondary source read in full.
Community	Widely said in the scene; no document proves it.
Vivian's field notes	First-hand experience, not a study.

Unverified

Plausible, not proven yet.

1 A house-wins game follows a recipe: a rule everyone knows, a picture at each win, effects that climb, and the house winning in the end.

Vivian's field notes

2 The player leaves with nothing kept except a best score.

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3 The kinks behind it are plain: being unable to resist a bet, and losing at a casino.

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6 Chips remove the money risk and leave the pull of the loop.

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7 Flashing content can also cause migraines, dizziness, nausea and seizures in some people.

Verified

Understanding Success Criterion 2.3.1: Three Flashes or Below Threshold | WAI | W3C (https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/three-flashes-or-below-threshold.html)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261001165853/https://www.w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/three-flashes-or-below-threshold.html)

Accessed 3 November 2026

8 A house-wins game with fictional chips is theatre.

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26 A visible table is the main difference between a wheel and a trap.

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39 The price of the guarantee is the price to judge.

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40 Retention designs are the engine of these tools.

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41 If you open the app out of habit, set a cap or remove it.

Vivian's field notes

42 Count the cost of keeping a card, not only the cost of getting it.

Vivian's field notes

43 A penalty for staying away is a reason to leave, never a reason to pay.

Vivian's field notes

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Vivian's field notes

45 A price I cannot say in one sentence is a price I do not charge.

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46 The sub plays blackjack, roulette or slots against the persona and sends what he bet.

Vivian's field notes

47 A loss is paid, and a win costs the persona nothing real.

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Vivian's field notes

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Unverified

50 The dom dares the sub to resist something nearly impossible to resist, there is no prize for winning, and the house wins every way.

Vivian's field notes

51 It is a kink, and it is also a money-pressure pattern outside play.

Vivian's field notes

52 Decide your cap first.

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Verified

Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 (https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261029121709/https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

59 A page can read the reduced-motion setting, which tells it whether the person asked their device to cut non-essential motion.

Reported

prefers-reduced-motion CSS media feature - CSS | MDN (https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/At-rules/@media/prefers-reduced-motion)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261031201800/https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/docs/Web/CSS/Reference/At-rules/%40media/prefers-reduced-motion)

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Verified

What's allowed in my profile text and images? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261026034619/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15810290-what-s-allowed-in-my-profile-text-and-images)

Accessed 3 November 2026

62 It also says that everything on a wishlist must be a gift.

Verified

What types of items can I add to my wishlist? (https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261019011312/https://help.throne.com/en/articles/15808792-what-types-of-items-can-i-add-to-my-wishlist)

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Unverified

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Vivian's field notes

67 One author compares some cases of this spending to problem gambling.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.